

Kassandra Hernández

CONTACT INFORMATION	650 Evans Hall Department of Economics, UC Berkeley	kassandra.hernandez@berkeley.edu Personal Website
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Labor Economics, Education, Immigration, Inequality, Public Policy	
EDUCATION	University of California, Berkeley Ph.D. in Economics	2021-Present
	UCLA Luskin School of Public Affairs Master of Public Policy (MPP)	2020
	Michigan State University AEA Summer Training Program (Advanced Track)	2020
	University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) B.A. in Philosophy (Labor Studies minor) Summa Cum Laude · College Honors · Departmental Honors	2017
ACADEMIC RESEARCH EXPERIENCE (GRADUATE LEVEL)	Graduate Research Fellow , UC Berkeley Labor Center <i>Advisor: Dr. Enrique Lopezlira</i>	2023-2026
	Graduate Research Fellow , California Policy Lab (UCB) <i>Advisor: Dr. Jesse Rothstein</i>	2022-2023
	Graduate Student Researcher , UCLA <i>Advisor: Dr. R. Jisung Park</i>	2019
POLICY RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Research Analyst , UCLA Latino Policy & Politics Institute <i>Advisor: Dr. Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas</i>	2021
	Research Fellow , UCLA LPPI <i>Advisor: Dr. Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas</i>	2020
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Instructor , PPIA Summer Institute – <i>Quantitative Methods</i> (undergraduate)	2024
	Teaching Associate , UCLA – <i>Using Data Science to Learn about Society</i> (undergraduate) – <i>Information, Evidence, and Persuasion</i> (undergraduate) – <i>Statistical Methods for Policy Analysis II</i> (graduate) – <i>MPP Summer Math Camp</i> (graduate, x2)	2019-2020
	Teaching Assistant , UCLA – <i>Statistical Methods for Policy Analysis I</i> (graduate) – <i>Research & Internships in Food Studies</i> (undergraduate, x2)	2019

ACADEMIC WORK IN PROGRESS	“When Constraints Bind: The Effects of the CA Dream Act Application on Undocu- mented Students Success,” with Teresita Cruz Vital	
	“Worker-led Lawsuits: The Effects of California’s Private Attorneys General Act on Business Behavior Across the State,” with Enrique Lopezlira	
	“Who Leads and Who Pays? Worker-led Enforcement and Differential Effects across Industries”	
	“Goodbye EFC, Hello SAI: How FAFSA Simplification Impacts Students’ Educational and Credit Outcomes,” with Hannah Case, Teresita Cruz Vital, and Steve Ramos	
	“Skills without the Bills? Apprenticeships, Career Technical Education, and Consumer Credit Outcomes” with Gaby Lohner and Steve Ramos	
FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS (GRADUATE)	<i>UC Office of the President,</i>	2026
	UC President’s Pre-Professoriate Fellowship (UC PPPF)	
	<i>UC Berkeley Institute for Research on Labor & Employment,</i>	2026
	Dissertation Fellowship	
	<i>Wheelhouse at UC Davis,</i>	2026
	Summer Scholars Fellowship	
	<i>California Policy Lab,</i>	2024
	Graduate Fellowship	
	<i>UC Berkeley,</i>	2024
	Outstanding Graduate Organization Leadership Award	
	<i>The Ford Foundation,</i>	2023
	Honorable Mention	
	<i>UC Berkeley,</i>	2021-2023
	Cota Robles Fellowship	
	<i>UC Berkeley Department of Economics,</i>	2021-2023
	Departmental Award	
	<i>AEA Summer Training Program,</i>	2020
	Best Paper in Advanced Track	
	<i>UCLA Luskin School of Public Affairs,</i>	2020
	MPP Commencement Speaker	
	<i>UCLA Luskin,</i>	2020
	Outstanding Academic Achievement	
	<i>UCLA Luskin,</i>	2020
	Teaching Assistant Award	
	<i>UCLA Luskin,</i>	2020
	Leadership & Service Award	
	<i>UCLA Luskin,</i>	2019
	Graduate Fellowship	
	<i>UCLA Luskin,</i>	2019
	Calvin and Marilyn Gross Fellowship	
	<i>UCLA,</i>	2019
	UC Regents Graduate Award	
	<i>UCLA,</i>	2018
	Graduate Opportunity Fellowship	

RESEARCH GRANTS	<i>W.E. Upjohn Institute & Russel Sage Foundation (RSF),</i>	2026
	– Dissertation Research Grant (\$15,000)	
	<i>Washington Center for Equitable Growth,</i>	2024
	– Early Career Grant (\$15,000)	
	<i>Family Policy to Reduce Racial Inequities in Health,</i>	2024
	– Graduate Student Research Award (\$30,000) <i>with Teresita Cruz Vital & Alessandro Marchetti-Bowick</i>	
	<i>UC Berkeley Institute for Research on Labor & Employment,</i>	2024
	– Graduate Student Research Award (\$6,000)	
	<i>California Policy Lab,</i>	2023
	– Seed Grant (\$7,443) <i>with Teresita Cruz Vital</i>	
	<i>UC Berkeley Economics,</i>	2021
	– Award for Gender-Related Research (\$9,000) <i>with Teresita Cruz Vital</i>	
SELECTED PRESENTATIONS	“When Constraints Bind: The Effects of the CA Dream Act Application on Undocumented Students Success”	
	– 2024-2025 AY : Freedom & Justice Summer Conference	
	– 2025-2026 AY : UC Berkeley Department of Economics Public Finance Seminar, Labor Lunch Series, Labor Mini Symposium; Western Economic Association International (WAEI) Annual Meeting	
	– 2026-2027 AY (Planned): Growing Our Own: A Graduate Research Symposium, UC Davis; Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting	
	“Worker-led Lawsuits: The Effects of California’s Private Attorneys General Act on Business Behavior Across the State”	
	– 2024-2025 AY : American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference; Freedom & Justice Summer Conference; Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting; Labor & Employment Relations Association (LERA)	
POLICY PUBLICATIONS	– 2025-2026 AY : Institute for Research on Poverty (IRP) Summer Research Workshop	
	– 2026-2027 AY (Planned): UC Berkeley IRLE Scholars Meeting; UC Berkeley Department of Economics Labor Lunch Series	
	“Demographic and Job Characteristics of Baltimore’s Security Guard Workforce” (2025). UC Berkeley Labor Center. –with Enrique Lopezlira & Nari Rhee	
	– Complementary work also considers the security guard workforce in: Seattle and Washington; California; United States	
	“Highlighting the Diversity of California’s Asian American and Pacific Islander Workforce” (2025). UC Berkeley Labor Center.	
	“Who are California’s American Indian and Alaska Native Low-wage Workers?” (2024). UC Berkeley Labor Center.	
	<i>Latinas Exiting the Workforce: How the Pandemic Revealed Historic Disadvantages and Heightened Economic Hardship</i> (2021). UCLA Latino Policy & Politics Institute (LPPI). –with Diana Garcia, Paula Nazario, Michael Rios, & Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas	
	<i>A Path to Prosperity: The Macroeconomic Benefits of Four Immigrant Regulariza-</i>	

tion Scenarios (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Raúl Hinojosa-Ojeda, Sherman Robinson, Marcelo Pleitez, Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, & Abel Valenzuela, Jr.

Disparities in the Distribution of Paycheck Protection Program Funds in California's Congressional Districts (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Paul M. Ong, Silvia R. Gonzalez, Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, Jonathan Ong, & Chhandara Pech.

Vote Choice of Latino Voters in the 2020 Presidential Election (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, Nick Gonzalez, Angela Gutierrez, Michael Herndon, Ana Oaxaca, Michael Rios, Marcel Roman, Tye Rush, & Daisy Vera.

Disparities in the Distribution of Paycheck Protection Program Funds Between Majority-White Neighborhoods and Neighborhoods of Color in California (2020). UCLA LPPI. –with Silvia R. Gonzalez, Paul M. Ong, Chhandara Pech, & Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas.

MEDIA COVERAGE & INTERVIEWS	English: Associated Press (AP) News; Forbes; The Hill; KPCC–NPR News; Washington Post; USA Today; ABC News; Milwaukee PBS; Voice of America Spanish: Telemundo; Univision–Los Angeles; Milwaukee PBS	
PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES & AFFILIATIONS	US Census Bureau: Special Sworn Status American Society for Hispanic Economists (ASHE) American Economic Association, Committee on the Status of Minority Groups in the Economics Profession (CSMGEP) Association for Economic Research of Indigenous Peoples (AERIP) AEA Summer Program Alumni (Advanced Track)	
PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT	Economics of Migration Summer Institute, UC Davis Stone Center Summer Institute on Inequality, UC Berkeley Path to the Professoriate Program, Office of Graduate Diversity	2023 2023 2021-2022
SERVICE	BEE Graduate Student Admission Review Committee Graduate Mentor, Getting Into Graduate School (GiGS) Leader, DEI Faculty Recruitment, BEE Graduate Mentor, Social Sciences Research Pathways Co-President, Economists for Equity at Berkeley (BEE) Invited Speaker: MPP & Beyond, PPIA Junior Summer Institute Committee Member/Doctoral Mentor, BEE Mentoring Program Student Liason, Emerging Scholars Reading Group Co-Leader, DEI Faculty Recruitment, BEE Organizing Member, UCLA Luskin Admission Review Committee Lead Convener, Kern Food Policy Council Working Groups AmeriCorps VISTA (placed at CSU Bakersfield)	2023-2026 2023-2026 2024-2025 2024-2027 2023-2024 2023 2022-2023 2022-2023 2022-2023 2018-2019 2017-2018 2017-2018
LANGUAGES	English (fluent); Spanish (native)	
SKILLS	Programming: Stata, R, SAS, $\text{\LaTeX}$ Policy: Reports, memos, briefs & blogs; media coverage (print, radio, television) Teaching: Content creation, instruction, management, grading, & 1-on-1 research guidance of graduate and undergraduate students	

CV Updated: September 18, 2026